

PROJECT KBP: Kapon, Bakuna kag Purga sa Ido kag Kuring

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Rationale

Here in the Philippines, having a pet at home is a tradition in every family. There is always a notion that a home is not complete without house pets. Owning pets may be dogs or cats, was said to promote good health and well-being to pet owners. Studies have proved they can help relieve stress, anxiety, and depression.

But owning a pet comes with great responsibility. Pet owners are supposed to provide basic pet needs such as deworming, vaccination, and sterilization (castration or ligation) when necessary. But for people who live in rural areas, access to veterinary services is very limited or difficult, if not impossible. Because of this, pets are commonly susceptible to intestinal parasitisms, infections such as rabies, and overpopulation.

Rabies is one of the deadly and very zoonotic diseases that affect our pets, our dogs, and cats; considered as a public health problem as it is one of the most acutely fatal infections, responsible for the deaths of at least 200 Filipinos each year. Rabies is a viral disease that is spread most often from the bite of a rabid animal to another animal or to a human. According to the World Health Organization, rabies is estimated to cause 59,000 human deaths annually in over 150 countries, with 95% of cases occurring in Africa and Asia (Herriman, 2022). Even though rabies is highly zoonotic and causes a high fatality rate, this disease is also preventable through vaccinations.

On the other hand, cats and dogs, especially puppies and kittens, are susceptible to intestinal parasites, including roundworms, hookworms, tapeworms, and whipworms. Deworming pets will assist in the prevention of illnesses caused by these intestinal parasites (Dinwiddie *et al.*, 2016). Dogs must be regularly dewormed because failing to do so can lead to more serious gastrointestinal problems. This is particularly important, especially for puppies and kittens, as this may cause growth retardation and other complications if worms are left untreated (White, 2020).

In veterinary practice, the castration of cats and dogs is one of the most common surgical procedures. Routine castrating is often performed because of its value in preventing reproductive tract disease, including benign prostatic hyperplasia and testicular neoplasia as well as in longevity of their life expectancy (<https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC6070019/>).

To support our government campaign, the Project KBP (Kapon, Bakuna, and Purga) of CapSU Dumarao greatly helps in the control of this very fatal rabies disease through free rabies vaccination, control over population via free castration and minimizing mortality because of parasitism through free deworming.

Objectives

Generally the project aims to cater the basic veterinary health care need of dogs and cats in the municipalities of Dumarao, Dumalag, and Dao, Capiz.

Specific Objectives:

1. To conduct free castration (kapon), rabies vaccination (bakuna) and deworming (purga) to dogs and cats to selected barangays in municipalities of Dumarao, Dumalag and Dao, Capiz.
2. To conduct seminar to pet owners for the responsible pet ownership and other related topics for the basic needs of their pets.
3. To provide IEC materials, flyers and other reading materials related to veterinary health care needs to all pet owners.
4. To conduct other activities related to the project activity (awareness seminar and training).

Project Description

In the Philippines, rabies disease is considered as a public health problem as it is one of the most acutely fatal infections, that affects majority of dogs and cats. According to Department of Health (2022), since January of this year until month of August, there was an official's report of 222 human rabies cases in 16 of the 17 regions across the country. One hundred (100%) of the cases ended in death. This data showed an increase of 17 percent compared to the same period in 2021, with 190 reported cases (Herriman, 2022). The Department of Health reported that the 16% of the cases were from Central Luzon, 13% were from Calabarzon, 11% were from Western Visayas, and 10% were from the Davao Region. With these data, World Health Organization, (WHO), reported that 99% of all rabies transmission are from dogs (DOH, 2021). In order to intensify the control of this deadly rabies diseases, the Department of Health together with other government agencies such as DA, DILG, NGOs and other private institution launched a program on rabies control and prevention and dream that the Philippines will be free of rabies cases by 2030. To support to this campaign, the Project KBP of Capiz State University Dumarao under the College of Veterinary Medicine is one of the support activity that will help pet owners, Department of Agriculture, LGUs, DOH and WHO to control this rabies disease. The project was a partnership project with the DA RFO 6, BAI, Capiz PVO, LGU officials in the municipalities of Dumarao, Dao and Dumalag, Capiz, CapSU Dumarao DVM Alumni and DVM students in the conduct of free castration (Kapon), free rabies vaccinations (Bakuna), and free deworming (Purga) to dogs and cats. The project also reach out and cater basic veterinary health care needs of dogs and cats in the municipalities of Dumarao, Dumalag, and Dao, Capiz. Beneficiaries enjoyed free castration and ligation, rabies vaccination and deworming of their animals. They were also trained via seminars and trainings which was conducted by different invited speakers from the Provincial Veterinary Office, Veterinary Clinic and from pet handler. This project was conducted from March 2022 until September 30, 2022.

The following are the specific activities conducted in this project:

- a. **Planning of the activities.** This was done through meetings with the different students and faculty in the College of Veterinary Medicine who joined in the activity. Planning was done by assigning of the committee who

take charge in communications, coordinations, budgets, procurements, printing of tarpaulins, programs, attendance and evaluation sheets, foods, registrations and other activities related to the project.

- b. **Coordination with the partner agencies, sponsors and the selected LGU and barangays.** Prior to project implementation, coordination with the selected LGU particularly in the office of the municipal agriculture office and mayors office were done to inform them of the activity in their municipality. The MAO officer identified participants in their municipality that has the highest number of dogs and cats. Coordination with the DA RFO 6, Capiz PVO were also done especially for their manpower contribution and for the veterinary materials needed in the project especially rabies vaccines and syringes.
- c. **Securing of permit from the IATF and MOA with the selected municipalities.** After coordination, a formal letter and a MOA were secured. Permit in the IATF were also processed to ensure that the activity follows the health protocol because of COVID 19 pandemic. All beneficiaries, students, speakers, veterinarians and volunteers were also required to follow the proper health protocol through wearing of facemask, social distancing, provision of alcohol stand, checking of body temperature and health checklist in the entrance of the project site.
- d. **Procurement of supplies needed.** Prior to project implementation, the proponents request budget in the administration particularly from Extension Office for the procurement of supplies such as medicines, surgical supplies and foods. Another way conducted was solicitation from different veterinary drug companies, CapSU CVM Alumni and some Veterinary Clinics.
- e. **Implementation of the project activities.** Project implementation was conducted from the month of March to September 2022 as part of the VETMED Week Celebration and World Rabies Day Celebration of the College of Veterinary Medicine. Simultaneous activity was conducted that includes seminars and trainings, castration, ligation, rabies vaccination, deworming and flyers/IEC materials distribution.
- f. **Follow up and monitoring of the project activity.** This was done one month after as part of the post surgical operation in the castration and ligation. Monitoring was done via phone call, video call or house to house visitation to the pet owners.

Results of Interventions

The table below shows the different results and actual accomplishment of the Project KBP: Kapon, Bakuna kag Purga sa Ido kag Kuring.

Expected Output	Details/ Conducted	Activities	Target	Actual Accomplishments	
				No.	%
People Services	Train/ orient pet owners for the basic veterinary health needs, responsible pet ownership and other related topics on dogs and cats.		300	317	105.67%

Products	Castrate/ ligate 30 dogs and cats.	30	60	200%
	Vaccinate 300 dogs and cats against rabies.	300	435	145%
	Deworm 100 dogs and cats.	100	65	65%
Places and Partnerships	Forge linkages and partnerships to LGU's of Dumarao, Dao and Dumalag, DA RFO 6, Capiz PVO, Veterinary Clinics and other organizations.	5	7	140%
Publications	Develop/ produce Information, Education and Communication (IEC) and promotional materials for responsible pet ownership, castration, vaccination and deworming. Develop promotional videos for the responsible pet ownership.	4	5	125%
Patents/IP	File 5 copyrights for the developed IEC materials and videos.	5	Drafted already for filing	
Policy	Develop one policy inputs to for the implementation of responsible pet ownership through Project KBP.	1	Draft one policy input to be endorsed in the three municipalities	
Impact to Community	Lessen the occurrence of rabies cases.	*Lessen the occurrence of rabies cases to 435 dogs and cats that were vaccinated from the three municipalities.		
	Control dog population.	*Stray dogs that causes several road accidents will be lessen through dog population control via castration and ligation.		
	Prevent dog and cat mortality due to parasitic diseases.	*Parasites are considered as major causes of death in dogs and cats, especially young ones. Through deworming, these parasites will be eliminated and controlled.		

	Responsible pet owners.	*Training and seminars on responsible pet owners as well as by giving them the IEC materials for a responsible pet ownership, helps the participants to be a responsible dog/ cat owners.
Impact to Socio - economic	Lessen/ save budget for castration and ligation, deworming and vaccination of their dogs and cats.	In a normal veterinary clinic, the following are the charges for: Castration/ Ligation budget : 1,000 – 3,000 pesos Deworming : 100 – 150 pesos Vaccination: 300 – 350 pesos If the owner has 3 dogs that were castrated at 3,000 pesos, he saved 9,000 pesos from the Project.

Testimonials/ Appreciation Message of the Partner Agencies and some Beneficiaries

- **LGUs** - All appreciate very much the Project KBP which are very big help to their constituents to avail the free kapon, bakuna kag purga sa ila ido kag kuring (free castration/ ligation, rabies vaccination and deworming to their dogs and cats).
- **Provincial Veterinary Office** – They are very thank ful for the initiative of Capiz State University in launching Project KBP that helps them in their fight against rabies cases and stray dogs.
- **DA Regulatory Division (Regional Rabies Coordinator)** – acknowledge Project KBP as one of the school activity that help them in their fight for rabies cases in the region. Also Dr. Lumaug has the opportunity to share rabies cases in the region and their initiatives done to control rabies cases.
- **DVM Students** – They were given opportunity to practiced what they learned inside classroom and applied it to the actual situation during the project implementation.
- **Pet Owners** – Pet owners who availed of services were so happy for the project since they had the chance to have their dog vaccinated, dewormed and castrated/ ligated without expenses.

Video clips on beneficiaries testimonies will be showed during video presentation.

Lessons Learned

This Project KBP has a lot of lessons that imparted to us project implementors. Through this project, we saw that there are so many pet owners who want their fur babies will also get the proper care such as deworming, rabies vaccination and even proper castration (because there are some cases that dogs were castrated using rubber band tied in their scrotum which is against the Animal Welfare Act). But they don't have the money to buy and pay to this basic needs of their pets. There are some areas who did not avail the LGU services due to problem in transportation and or they in remote areas. As veterinarian, it is therefore I conclude that having this activity to the less fortunate pet owners is of great help for them to free from danger of rabies

cases, lessen mortality, and decreased stray dogs and cats along the highway that leads to car accidents.

Recommendations

The Project KBP implementors would like to recommend that this extension activity will be implemented yearly in the three municipalities of Dumarao, Dao and Dumalag, Capiz, since the rabies vaccine expires after one year and need to follow up annually. This project will be implemented not only in the selected three municipalities but also in all sixteen towns and one city in the province of Capiz. More collaboration and linkages to other agencies and institutions will also be conducted.

PHOTOS DURING PROJECT IMPLEMENTATION





